

These are the steps to getting students to switch to Panda. **Focus on ONE university at a time** for best success (and for the trial/error learning- this will be helpful before moving on to the next university)

1. **Finalize Our Non-negotiable Features** (physical sim card, and chat/phone customer service in english/mandarin & even cantonese)
2. **Launch Our Deal Incentive** (let's start with the referral program & leave the special student discount for later).
 - a. This is important b/c as we saw in the research, students will only switch if there's something wrong with their current plan (like the signal) OR if there's some incentive that makes a new carrier cheaper overall relative to their current carrier (a lower price/discount) - a deal that makes people feel like their saving \$.
 - b. I want to reiterate that **this does NOT mean Panda needs to be the cheapest of all brands - just a better deal relative to 1 brand** (e.g. people on Big Wireless family plans paying ~\$35 for unlimited plan). So, **marketing is very important here - specifically, targeting people on family plans so that to THEM, our small discount or referral incentive is very competitive**. Example: if we offer them a simple \$5 referral/discount, this will already be \$5 cheaper than their plan **AND** they won't have the hassle that comes with a family plan + they'll get some chinese focused features + the unlimited savings from the referral program. So to them, this would be a A GREAT DEAL (more than to people from carriers like Mint mobile or ENC). In conclusion, **we don't have to trade off much financially if we target the right people (marketing is key)**.
 - i. "Bye bye family plans! Get the savings without the hassle"
3. **Strengthen/Prepare Our Brand**
 - a. A brand that cares about Chinese students & wants to help them with their transitions/challenges
 - i. On our website, offer a resource page that focuses on challenges/transitions Chinese students face when coming to US (e.g. student real estate agents in top 10 key cities, etc.) & WeChat groups per top cities (so students can join and discuss Panda Mobile service in their area or request/discuss resources with other students)
 - ii. When brainstorming meetings/events/giveaways, focus them around helping students with challenges they may face (e.g. events for networking/practicing english, giveaways that are focused on challenges- one common challenge is not having a car to drive places, so gift cards to Uber, Amazon, or food delivery services would be helpful)
 - b. A brand that is very competitive to Big Wireless Family Plans
 - i. Target family plan students! "Bye bye family plans! Get the savings without the hassle"
 1. See #2b for this: **as we already are, we are most valuable to these students!** Because we ALREADY offer a comparable price relative to family plan price AND more: no hassle that comes with family plans, unlimited savings with our referral program, and chinese features like international calling!
 - ii. Ensure all our ads/posters/presentations target these students the most (at least to start/kick off our brand)
 - c. Great signal
 - i. Emphasize 5G and our T-mobile towers (launch our marketing campaigns in areas where students believe T-mobile has good signal - signal is word-of-mouth heavy)

4. Word-of-mouth Entry Point

- a. Students make decisions based on word of mouth from trusted sources (friends, family, or organizations they trust - like CSSA/CUSA)
- b. So, our best bet (especially as a new brand) is to reach the initial wave of student customers via CSSA/CUSA.
 - i. Sponsor the food at their meetings in exchange for a short presentation
 - ii. Sponsor events in exchange for our brand placement/ads
 - iii. Provide giveaways at their meetings/events (challenge-focused giveaways aka gift cards to grocery stores or food delivery like Wee! Or to Uber/Amazon since students don't have a car to drive around & go places or buy things)
- c. Place ads on campus ("Bye bye family plans! Get the savings without the hassle!")
- d. Without this type of word of mouth, we don't have trust (especially as in this community & as a new brand)

5. Word-of-mouth Spread

- a. CSSA/CUSA helps us with the initial exposure & trust, but we need a way to spread continuously & organically (because events are limited).
- b. A referral program (\$5/month for every successful referral - for you & the person you refer- NO CAP, unlimited savings!)
 - i. This is good b/c it's still word-of-mouth marketing - so the trust is still there.
 - ii. Also, this community is more savings/deal motivated. And, customers won't see \$5 here, they'll see **unlimited savings!** And as we know, referrals in this community spread like wildfire b/c people love to save as much as they can AND the community is very tight knit (1 person will post their referral in several WeChat groups & each WeChat group has up to 500 people!)
- c. A marketing internship program (for business/marketing/entrepreneurship students)
 - i. Students will help develop & implement marketing strategies (referral programs, giveaways, on campus events, etc.). This will be a great resume building experience for them & great word-of-mouth marketing for us.
 - ii.

In summary: First, we need to ensure our product is ready by solidifying key features (physical SIM, customer service in English/Mandarin/Cantonese) and launching a financial incentive, starting with the referral program and potentially adding a student discount later. Next, we must establish ourselves as a trusted word-of-mouth brand through in-person engagement with CSSA and posters on campus/malls, while ensuring our marketing clearly communicates that we offer a competitive deal compared to big wireless family plans. Finally, we need to turn our customers into brand advocates by leveraging referrals and internships to drive organic growth. **This will be a gradual process, as people are on contracts. But, in the end, word-of-mouth is our best bet (once 1 generation of students & CSSA/CUSA trusts us, they'll inform the next generation & so on...)**